

3v3 Community Cup

Tournament rules, 2026



DATE	WHERE	DIVISIONS	ROSTER
Sat 28 Nov 2026	Sully Highlands Park	U8 to U14, boys and girls	3 to 6 players

01 Rosters and player eligibility

- Teams need **at least 3 players and no more than 6**. Four or five is a typical roster.
- Register in the division of your **oldest player**. For 2026-27 age groups run **August 1 to July 31**, not by calendar birth year, so check the table above before you enter.
- A player born in September 2016 is U10, and a player born in June 2016 is U11, even though both were born in the same calendar year. Players born between August and December are the ones most likely to have moved.
- Divisions may be combined if entries are light in any bracket.
- Girls' divisions are reserved for girls. Girls may also play in boys' divisions.
- Players must have hard-copy or digital proof of age at check-in. A birth certificate or other acceptable proof of age must be supplied when requested.

02 Equipment and uniforms

- Shin guards are mandatory for every player, no exceptions.
- Any soccer-appropriate footwear is allowed unless stated otherwise. Indoor venues may restrict cleats.
- Game balls are provided. U8 through U12 use a size 4 ball, U13 and U14 use a size 5.
- Wear matching shirts. Jersey numbers are optional.
- Bring two contrasting shirt colors so teams can resolve color conflicts.

03 Field, goal box and scoring

- Fields measure approximately 24 to 30 yards by 16 to 20 yards. Dimensions may vary with the venue.
- The goal box measures 8 feet across and 4 feet deep. Players can move through it but cannot play the ball inside it.
- A defender touching the ball in the box gives the opponent a goal. An attacker touching it in the box gives the defending team a goal kick.
- A ball that comes to rest in the box results in a goal kick for the defending team.
- A scoring shot must be taken from the attacking half.

04 Match format and substitutions

- Play two 12-minute halves with a 2-minute halftime.
- One-day events provide at least four games, potentially six or seven with playoffs. Multi-day formats provide at least six, potentially eight or more with playoffs.
- Substitute during a stoppage with the referee's permission.
- Pool matches can finish tied. Playoff matches require a winner.
- Blowout rule.** A team that falls **six goals behind may add a fourth player**. Once the margin comes back to five, that extra player comes off. There is no mercy rule and no early finish, every game plays its full two halves.

05 Restarts and special playing rules

- No offside. Sliding is prohibited and results in an indirect free kick.
- Heading is permitted in U11 and older divisions.
- Defenders stay at least 10 feet from the ball at dead-ball restarts.
- Restart within five seconds, subject to referee discretion.
- Use kick-ins in place of throw-ins. Restarts are indirect except for corner kicks and penalties.
- Take goal kicks from anywhere on the end line, outside the goal box. Kickoffs may travel in any direction.
- Take penalties from the center spot, with all other players behind midfield. A missed penalty does not remain live.

06 Standings, tiebreakers and playoffs

Pool standings award **3 points for a win, 1 for a tie and 0 for a loss**. A forfeit is recorded as a 5-0 loss.

Resolve standings ties in this order

- Head-to-head result, when exactly two teams are tied.
- Goal difference.
- Fewest goals allowed.
- Most goals scored.
- A system-generated coin toss.

Tied playoff matches

Play one three-minute golden-goal period. If no one scores, the three players who finished the game take part in a penalty shootout.

07 Conduct and tournament authority

- Referees can issue cards to players or coaches. A red-carded player leaves the current match and is suspended for the next one.
- The Tournament Director may remove players, coaches or teams for misconduct. When the responsible coach cannot be identified, the head coach is sanctioned.
- Referee abuse is not tolerated. Unsporting conduct can lead to removal or disqualification of teams, coaches or spectators.
- The Tournament Director decides situations these rules do not address.

08 Tournament-day check-in

- Enter every player's name and date of birth in **PlayMetrics** before the entry deadline. In PlayMetrics go to My Teams, open your team, then Manage Roster. Do not use the purple Register button, your team is already registered. Jersey numbers are edited under More Actions.
- Check in at your game-site headquarters **30 minutes before the first match**.
- Bring an official team roster, either the tournament form or one produced by your club. Jersey numbers are not required.
- Have a hard copy or digital proof of age for every player.
- The team coach or parent must certify on the team check-in form that signed medical releases are in their possession for every player. Keep those releases at every game. They are not collected as check-in documents.
- Tournament, club or other generic medical release forms may be used.